Tokyo Travel Guide - Japan

Overview

Tokyo, Japan's bustling capital, blends ultramodern skyscrapers with historic temples. It offers world-class shopping, dining, technology and cultural experiences.

Best Time to Visit

Spring (March-May) is ideal for cherry blossoms with temperatures of 10-19 C. Autumn (September-November) offers mild weather and colorful foliage. Summer is hot and humid (25-31 C), while winter is cool and dry (2-10 C).

Top Attractions

Senso-ji Temple - Tokyo's oldest Buddhist temple in Asakusa.

Shibuya Crossing - the world's busiest pedestrian crossing.

Tokyo Skytree - one of the tallest towers in the world with observation decks.

Meiji Shrine - a serene Shinto shrine surrounded by forest in the middle of the city.

Akihabara - the center of anime, manga and electronics culture.

Local Transportation

The Tokyo subway and JR train network are extensive, punctual and easy to navigate with an IC card such as Suica or Pasmo. The Japan Rail Pass is cost-effective for travelers also visiting other cities.

Estimated Daily Budget

Budget travelers: approximately 60-80 USD per day including hostel stay, convenience store meals and train pass. Mid-range travelers: 150-220 USD per day for hotel stay and restaurant meals. Luxury travelers: 400 USD and above per day.

Travel Guidelines

Most nationalities need a visa or visa waiver arrangement. Cash is still widely used, though IC cards and credit cards are increasingly accepted. Public behavior is expected to be quiet, particularly on trains. Tipping is not customary in Japan.